

MARGARET L. ELLISON

Prospect Research & Portfolio Optimization Leader

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SUMMARY

Prospect research and management leader with 20 years at Lakeshore University. Supports about 70 frontline fundraisers and managers across Development and Alumni Relations. Builds the reporting, data, and prospect management systems the division uses to find donors, manage portfolios, and forecast revenue for university leadership.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

LAKESHORE UNIVERSITY, Columbus, OH

Feb 2006 – Present

Director, Advancement Research

Jun 2009 – Present

- Developed and maintained the portfolio management dashboards, research report templates, and CRM prospect management systems used by about 70 frontline fundraisers and their managers across Development and Alumni Relations, helping them maximize their fundraising success.
- Identified, researched, and recommended potential gift donors (individuals, corporations, foundations) through data mining and developing new channels. That work enabled fundraisers to pursue donors that provided major funding for school, center, institute, and university-wide initiatives.
- Recruited, trained, and managed a team of five research analysts and one administrative assistant, ensuring research is accurate and on time.
- Managed the Advancement Research budget to provide the office with the latest and most effective research tools.
- Developed the gift pyramid and prospect list for a campus student center's successful \$2.5 million renovation campaign.
- Managed Principal Gift Meetings to create a pipeline of high-level Horizon campaign donors, including solicitation of trustees for Horizon gifts.
- Oversaw prospect assignment, contacting development officers with conflicting assignments and consulting with the VP of Advancement and associate VPs to resolve conflicts and optimize assignments.

Interim Director, Advancement Research

Mar 2008 – Jun 2009

- Reorganized the Athletics prospect pool, reassigning 150+ prospects more efficiently among five development officers.
- Created and led a team of development officers and their staff to manage prospect data in a database management system.

Research Analyst, Advancement Research

Feb 2006 – Mar 2008

- Researched select foundations and corporations and proactively found new potential donors for the Office of Foundation and Corporate Relations.
- Conducted targeted research for events and donor profiles.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- **\$4.8B raised across three campaigns:** Research and prospect management partner for three university campaigns, each of which exceeded its goal.
- **Launched leadership's first reliable forecasts:** Spent five years improving prospect management data and built a Tableau pipeline report the division now relies on to forecast for leadership and manage the division more effectively.
- **120+ employees led and trained:** Led the team responsible for all prospect management training across the division, from new-hire onboarding to ongoing training.

SKILLS

Prospect Development: Potential gift donor identification, capacity research, data mining, corporate and foundation research

Prospect Management & Analytics: Portfolio management, pipeline reporting and forecasting, dashboards, data quality

Tools: Tableau, CRM prospect management systems

Leadership: Team management, training program design and delivery, budget management

EDUCATION

Master of Business Administration, Lakeshore University, Columbus, OH

1990

Bachelor of Business Administration, Accounting, Riverside State University, Dayton, OH

1988

SPEAKING ENGAGEMENTS

- "Modern Methods in Prospect Research," Regional Philanthropy Conference, 2012
- "Prospect Research 101," Nonprofit Education Day, 2011
- "Finding the Next Major Donor," State Nonprofit Association Conference, 2011
- "Using Research Effectively," local nonprofit development team